

Purpose: Guidelines for code contribution and deployment.

Section 1: Version Control and Branching We utilize a trunk-based development strategy. All engineers must clone repositories from the central Bitbucket server.

- **Branch Naming:** Branches must follow the format: `feature/JIRA-1234-short-description` or `bugfix/JIRA-5678-issue`.
- **Commits:** Commit messages must be descriptive and reference the Jira ticket number.

Section 2: Code Review Process Before merging into the `main` branch, a Pull Request (PR) must be opened.

- At least two peer approvals are required.
- Automated SonarQube static analysis must pass with zero critical vulnerabilities and a code coverage minimum of 80%.
- The build pipeline must successfully compile and pass all automated BDD tests.

Section 3: Deployment Schedules Production deployments occur bi-weekly on Tuesdays and Thursdays at 10:00 AM EST. Staging deployments happen automatically upon merging to the `main` branch via our Jenkins CI/CD pipeline. No direct commits to the `main` branch are permitted.